

Capstone Preview — "Holocron"

Hand-out ahead of Week 8. A look at the capstone problem — enough to get you thinking, not the full brief. In Week 8 your quad becomes the Technical Product Manager for this problem and builds the complete artifact set. This preview gives you the situation and the stakes; the requirements will be yours to write.

The problem

Across a large enterprise, the text in every user interface — labels, buttons, error messages, help text, legal notices — is managed inconsistently. Much of it is **hardcoded directly in application code**; the rest is scattered across files owned by whoever built the screen.

The result: **changing a single sentence requires an engineer and a deployment.** A one-word fix to a legal disclaimer or a confusing error message turns into a ticket, a code change, a review, and a release. Work that should take minutes takes days or weeks.

Why it matters

- **Delivery drag** — engineering time is burned on text edits that carry no engineering value.
- **Compliance risk** — some strings are legally sensitive, with no consistent review gate and no durable record of who approved what, and when.
- **Global inconsistency** — decentralized ownership across a business that spans **150+ countries, 30–40 languages, 20–30+ applications, and on the order of 500,000 strings.**

The mandate

Leadership has asked for *"a centralized, governed way to manage UI text so content owners can create, review, and publish it without hardcoding or redeploying — while preserving traceability, ownership, and approval controls."*

That one sentence is the entire direction you'll be given.

What it should actually do, for whom, in what order, and to what quality bar — that is your work.

What you'll do

Over four working days, your quad turns that mandate into the full artifact chain you have built all course —

Discovery → PRD → TCD + TMD → AI Spec → SEP + DP — and presents it Friday.

You will not be handed requirements; you will write them. And because no team can specify everything an enterprise platform *could* do in a week, a real part of the challenge is **choosing a defensible first slice** — the capabilities that make release one genuinely useful — and defending what you deliberately left for later, and why.

Everything you have practiced since Week 1 shows up here at once. Come ready to make calls. The full problem brief — with the facts, the stakeholders, the dependencies, and what's already been ruled out — arrives when the capstone begins.